

July 11, 2026

Dear Brithany Ramos,

As I reflected on the people who have made a difference in my life, one conversation immediately came to mind. Today I want to thank you for that moment because it has stayed with me ever since. It happened after one of our classes in high school, when we were sitting in the car talking. At that time, we were still getting to know each other and hadn't started dating yet. Our conversation started naturally, but it was you who asked the questions that helped me open up. For the first time in a long time, I felt comfortable sharing what I had been keeping inside.

You listened to me without interrupting or judging me. Instead, you patiently let me express everything I was feeling and then kindly shared your thoughts and advice. Because you took the time to truly listen, I finally felt understood and was able to organize my thoughts. Before that conversation, I felt overwhelmed. By the time we finished talking, I felt calmer, encouraged, and ready to move forward. That simple moment reminded me that I do not have to face every challenge alone and that sometimes sharing our burdens gives us the strength to keep going.

Even today, I still remember that conversation whenever I feel overwhelmed or begin to doubt myself. It was one of the first times I realized what kind of person you are: someone who truly listens, cares, and supports others. Your kindness that day continues to influence me, and I am grateful that you chose to be there for me. Thank you for listening to me with patience, for encouraging me when I needed it most, and for continuing to support me every day. I will always be grateful for that conversation because it reminds me that I never have to face life's challenges alone.

Sincerely,

Saúl Abraham Arana Calderón